

Startup Cost Estimate

The Cleaning CEO Blueprint — 100% Cleaner Academy

Solo Operator — Minimum Launch

Category	Low	High
LLC + filing fees	\$50	\$500
Business license	\$0	\$150
General liability insurance (year 1)	\$400	\$1,200
Supplies (first kit)	\$150	\$300
Equipment (vacuum, mop, etc.)	\$300	\$600
Uniform	\$50	\$100
Website (DIY)	\$0	\$200
Domain + email	\$30	\$80
Business phone	\$0	\$30/mo
Marketing (photos, cards, flyers)	\$50	\$300
TOTAL	\$1,030	\$3,460

Two-Cleaner Operation

Category	Est. Cost
Everything above	\$1,030–\$3,460
Second supply kit	\$150
Second vacuum	\$150–\$400
Second uniform	\$50
Storage unit (monthly)	\$80–\$200/mo
Scheduling software	\$0–\$50/mo

Additional	\$430–\$850 + monthly
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Monthly Operating Costs (Steady State)

Expense	Solo	2 Cleaners	5 Cleaners
Insurance	\$40–\$100	\$80–\$150	\$150–\$300
Supplies	\$100–\$200	\$200–\$400	\$500–\$800
Marketing	\$50–\$300	\$100–\$500	\$300–\$1,000
Software / phone	\$30–\$80	\$50–\$150	\$100–\$300
Storage	\$0–\$150	\$80–\$200	\$150–\$400
Payroll (cleaners)	\$0	\$3,000+	\$8,000+
Owner salary	Your draw	Your draw	Your draw
Fixed (excl. payroll)	\$220–\$830	\$510–\$1,400	\$1,200–\$2,800

Break-Even Math

Example — Solo owner-operator:

- Average profit per job: \$50 (after supplies, if paying yourself separately)
- Jobs needed to cover \$500/mo fixed costs: **10 jobs/month**
- At 4 jobs/week: break-even in ~2.5 weeks on fixed costs only

Example — Owner + 1 cleaner:

- Your profit per job: \$50 company margin
- 20 jobs/month = \$1,000 company profit
- Covers fixed costs + reinvestment

Funding Options

1. **Bootstrap** — Start with one kit, reinvest first 10 job profits
2. **Business credit card** — Pay in full monthly; build credit responsibly

3. **Small business loan** — Only after proven revenue (3+ months books)

4. **Personal savings** — Keep 3 months operating expenses in reserve

Never borrow more than you can repay from projected month-2 revenue.